SEED ROUND · $750,000

Somnora

A private AI companion for your dreams, days and ideas, on iPhone and Apple Watch.



James McShane, founder
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WHY I BUILT IT

A private place to put things down

For 13 years I shot documentaries. Some of what I filmed was heavy. I'd carry it home, or sit with it in the field with no one to talk to: sometimes because of an NDA, sometimes because I didn't want to say it to a person.

"I wanted somewhere private I could trust. It feels like someone's listening, and there's comfort in knowing I'm never being judged."

Dream

Hard shoots brought vivid, recurring dreams I wanted to understand.

Eureka

Back home, big ideas arrived at odd moments. One tap on the Watch had to be enough.

Daily

The days in between, worked through with the same companion.

THE PROBLEM

The missing middle

People have their most honest thoughts at the edges of the day, and most of it is gone by morning. Wearables record the body. Journals store words. General AI assistants forget, or remember in ways people can't see or correct.

	Wearables	**Journals and meditation apps**	**Somnora**
Body context	Strong: biometrics	Minimal	Apple Health trends against your own baseline
Inner context	None	Self-reported only	Dreams, days and ideas
What it remembers	Metrics without meaning	Static entries	Nora: memory you can see, correct and clear

THE PRODUCT

One companion for three moments

Dream

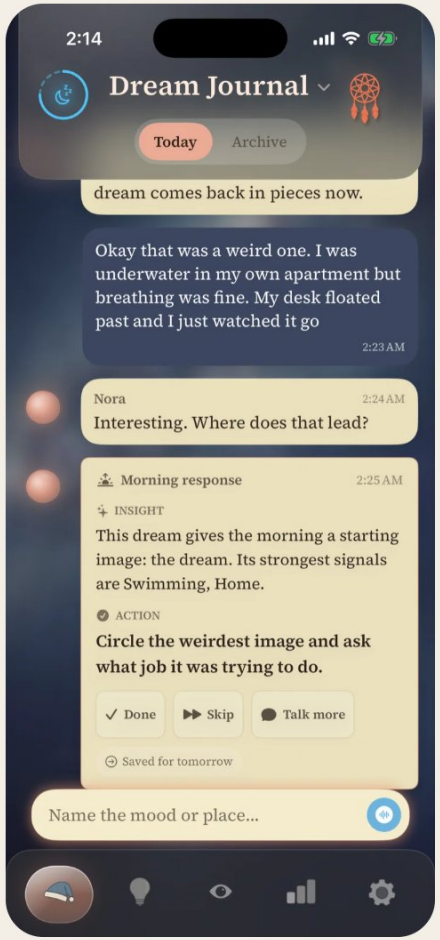
Capture a dream by voice or text when you wake. Nora reflects on what repeats and can offer one small next step.

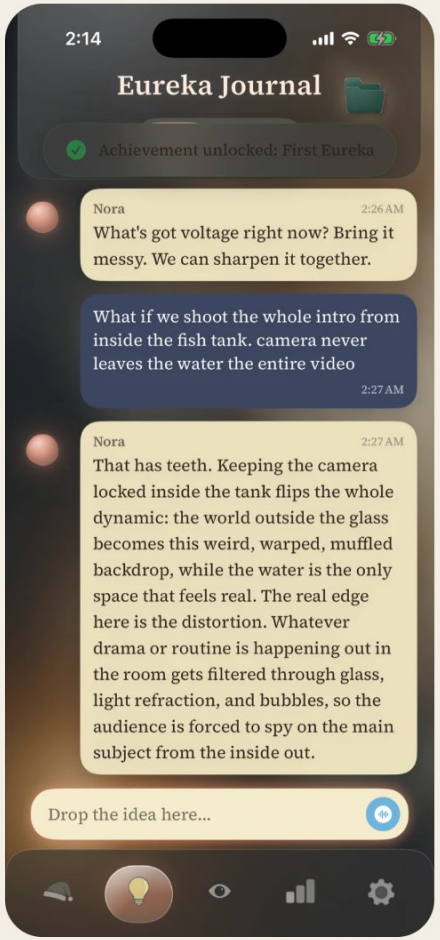
Daily

Work through the day with a companion that builds on what you've already shared.

Eureka

Catch an idea on the Apple Watch in seconds, then sharpen it together on the phone.





HOW IT WORKS

From a fragment to a clearer next step

01

Capture

Voice or text in seconds: a dream, a check-in or an idea. The Watch hands off to the phone.

02

Context

With permission, sleep timing, HRV and resting heart rate from Apple Health, read against your own baseline.

03

Conversation

Nora replies as a companion: short first, observant, never a score or a diagnosis.

04

Patterns

On-device motif detection, nightly memory consolidation, and at most one earned check-in a day.

The result: a private record of what repeats, and a calmer next step when the evidence has earned it.

TRUST

Privacy is part of the product

On the device first

Motifs, memory consolidation and health trends run on the phone. Chat is privacy-sanitized on its way through Somnora's own server.

Your words stay yours

Somnora doesn't train public models on what people write, and doesn't sell user data.

You stay in control

See, edit and clear what Nora remembers. Export or delete everything. Face ID lock. Analytics stay off unless you opt in.

Consumer and non-clinical by design: no diagnosis, and no insurer or employer in the loop.

WHERE SOMNORA STANDS

Shipped, live, and early

1.2.1
Live on the App Store since April 2026; latest release October 29

50–100
people have tried it, counting TestFlight testers and friends

25
first-time App Store downloads

5 of 5
App Store ratings are five stars

Return visits and paid conversion aren't measured yet; measuring them is this round's first milestone. Built solo, end to end: the iPhone and Apple Watch apps, the server, the art service and subscriptions.

BUSINESS MODEL

Freemium, paid for by the person

Free

A weekly allowance of Nora conversations and Dreamcatcher art, with every privacy control included.

Premium

$9.99 a month or $59.99 a year. More Nora, more Dreamcatcher art, and deeper pattern reads.

Built to stay lean

Weekly quotas, on-device first passes and selective model routing keep free users cheap. Target: premium gross margin above 65% at scale, after Apple's 15% fee.

Not known yet: conversion, renewal and the cost to serve each user. Measuring them is what this round is for.

GO TO MARKET

Reach comes first

In the 90 days to October 28, about 4 people a day saw Somnora in the App Store, and about 1 in 20 of them downloaded it.

Step 1

Find a channel that works

One test at a time, each with a budget, campaign links and a stop rule: Apple Search Ads, sleep and dream creators, Somnora's sleep-ambience YouTube channel, and live-action spots shot in-house.

Step 2

Check that people stay and pay

Week-4 return and paid conversion for each channel's users, against thresholds set before measuring.

Step 3

Scale the one that clears both bars

Put the budget behind it, with runway to keep improving Nora.

TEAM

Built end to end by its founder

James McShane, founder, full-time

THE STORYTELLER

13 years in documentary cinematography, shaping emotionally precise stories and projects that raised $4M+ for conservation.

THE BUILDER

Designed, built and shipped every layer of Somnora with AI development tools: the iPhone and Apple Watch apps, the server on Google Cloud, the art service and subscriptions. Also built Manifold, a tool for running GPU workloads in the cloud.

MARKETING ADVISOR

Charles Geobeaud, Unreasonable Studios

PROGRAMS

Google for Startups · NVIDIA Inception

FUNDING SO FAR

No outside cash. $57.5K in cloud credits from Google, AWS and Lambda.

THE ROUND

$750,000

to find the channel that brings people who stay and pay

Mostly marketing

Channel tests, one at a time, each with a budget and a stop rule.

Measurement

Week-4 return and paid conversion for every channel's users.

Runway

Time to keep improving Nora while the winning channel scales.

Somnora LLC is registered in Los Angeles and converts to a Delaware C-corp for the round; the founder is based in the Philadelphia area.

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